

Podenzano, 24.09.2026

Letter of recommendation — Maël Cadiou

To whom it may concern,

I am Sales Manager for the European export markets at Sideros Engineering S.r.l., a position I have held since 2015. Our company manufactures sheet metal handling and automation systems in Podenzano, Italy, and exports to more than fifty countries. The European accounts and the prospect portfolio entrusted to Maël fall under my responsibility, and he reported directly to me throughout his internship. Before joining Sideros I spent around fifteen years in international sales, in Italy and abroad, including several years leading commercial teams and export networks across Europe. I mention this only because it is the background against which I have worked with a fair number of young people at the start of their career.

Maël Cadiou worked under my supervision as a commercial intern during the summer of 2026. His assignment was to reactivate a dormant portfolio of European prospects and to follow up the contacts collected at our trade shows. Over the period he opened contact with 811 companies across some forty countries, sending more than a thousand messages which he wrote himself in French, English, Italian, Spanish and German, covering five of our product lines: welding positioners, automated storage towers, dust extraction, Zero Gravity manipulators and deburring, and seven trade shows, from Global Industrie and Tolexpo in France to EuroBlech, Blechexpo and Schweissen & Schneiden in Germany.

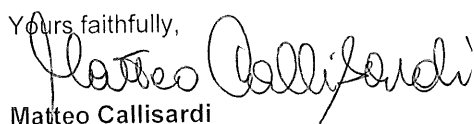
The campaign produced a response rate of around six per cent, a solid result for cold outreach to a dormant base in our sector, and roughly twenty qualified opportunities handed over to our sales team. No order was signed during his internship: our equipment involves investments of several hundred thousand euros and decision cycles of twelve to twenty-four months, so this was never the measure of his work. His role was to create the opportunities, and he did so.

He was also responsible for the French version of our complete commercial presentation, ninety-four slides and of several technical brochures, with real attention to the technical vocabulary. This material is now in use with our French-speaking network.

What I valued most was his autonomy. He needed little supervision, asked the right questions when something was unclear, and organised his own work over the whole period. He also developed his Italian over these weeks, moving from a hesitant spoken level to a more confident one through his interaction with the team which is not always an obvious thing in an industrial environment.

Maël is now moving towards a career in finance. In my experience, what makes the difference in any client-facing role is not the product but the ability to listen, to follow up without being reminded, and to move between languages and cultures without effort. He has all three, and I recommend him sincerely. I remain available for any further information.

Yours faithfully,

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Matteo Callisardi".

Matteo Callisardi

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